Week 11: Presentations, Speeches and Interviews

NPTEL Soft Skills · Prof. Binod Mishra · Lectures 51–55

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Lecture 51: Making Effective Presentations

Week 11 · Course book PDF pages 832–851 (printed pages 831–850)

Learning objectives

- List the features of an effective presentation: beginning, voice, body language, humour, examples, ending.
- Explain the role of practice and rehearsal, including timing and self-recording.
- Describe delivery factors: expressiveness, rate, volume, pitch, articulation, appearance.
- Use visual aids, PPT slides and connectives effectively.
- State tips for the delivery day and recall Freud and Confucius.

Important definitions

EFFECTIVE PRESENTATION

A presentation that captivates at the start, is clear in voice and body language, uses humour and familiar examples, integrates aids and ends emphatically.

REHEARSAL (PRACTICE)

Repeated, timed practice of the presentation, ideally recorded and reviewed.

EXPRESSIVENESS

The quality of voice and body in conveying the intended meaning.

RATE

Speed of speaking in words per minute.

PITCH MOVEMENT / INTONATION

Rise and fall of voice to give emphasis and emotion.

CONNECTIVES (SIGNPOSTS)

Transitions, internal previews and internal summaries that show the audience where the speaker is.

LECTERN

A stand for notes that may also hide nervousness.

DESENSITISATION

Telling oneself positive things and visualising success to reduce anxiety.

Core concepts

Effective beginning

- Capture attention: a question, story, anecdote, episode or startling fact; avoid an abrupt start.
- Example: “There is one thing common to all of us...and that is nervousness.”
- Memorise the first lines and any quotation fully, with the name of the author, to avoid embarrassment.

Voice and body language

- **Voice:** clear and articulate; speak slowly enough that words are not eaten; voice can be trained.
- **Body language:** eye contact with all sections of the audience; stand firmly; use space naturally; gestures that match the message; avoid too frequent movement and fidgeting.
- **Freud:** “He who has eyes to see and ears to listen can convince himself that no mortal can keep a secret...betrayal oozes out of him at every pore.”

Humour and examples

- Humour relieves technical subjects (e.g. dentist joke) and sustains attention.
- Use familiar examples suited to the audience (sports, music, movies; for yoga, a mix).

Ending

End **emphatically** with a restatement and signposts (‘before I close...’); summarise main points; do not end abruptly or limply.

Practice and rehearsal

- Confidence cannot be gained in a day; rehearse repeatedly.
- Prepare a final **outline**; do not read word for word.
- **Time** yourself with a clock; cut points if too long; record on a cell phone to review body language, eye contact and voice.
- Be your own critic; give small presentations to friends for honest feedback; use a mirror.

PPT slides

- Use slides as an outline: only essential points, a limited number per slide; no clutter or reading from slides (same as reading from manuscript).
- Animation without ‘music of thought’ is useless.

Delivery factors

- **Expressiveness** of voice and body.
- **Rate:** moderate – the lecture cites 120–130 words per minute versus 180 as too fast.
- **Volume:** audible; adjust to hall, crowd and acoustics; keep a little distance from the microphone.
- **Pitch and intonation:** vary emphasis.
- **Articulation:** clear syllables.
- **Appearance:** formal, presentable dress, haircut, bearing; avoid distracting items (earrings, cell phones).

Visual aids and connectives

- Integrate aids at the relevant point; interpret them; do not stand between the aid and the audience (OHP failure).
- Use pointers properly.
- In speech we use **connectives** instead of punctuation: transitions, internal previews, internal summaries; signposts such as ‘finally’, ‘last but not the least’, ‘before I close’.

Tips

- Prepare thoroughly, practise repeatedly, time yourself.
- Use a lectern if needed; microphone etiquette (no shouting).
- Stress busters: desensitise, visualise success, begin with a pause, speak the first sentence from memory, keep eye contact, slow down.
- Move naturally; ignore smiles and whispers or treat them as appreciation.
- Do not read, do not memorise everything, no long introduction, no ‘verbal bullets’, avoid frowning.
- Keep writing and speaking when using a blackboard.
- Stand with one foot ahead of the other; avoid fidgeting.
- Give handouts after; stay for questions; if you cannot answer, offer to discuss later; end with summary and appreciation.
- **Confucius:** “A superior man is modest in his speech but exceeds in his actions.”

Types, classifications and characteristics

Features of effective delivery

Feature	Guidance
Beginning	Question, story, anecdote, startling fact
Voice	Clear, moderate rate, audible, varied pitch
Body language	Eye contact, natural gestures, firm stance
Humour/examples	Familiar, relevant
Aids	Integrated, interpreted
Ending	Emphatic recapitulation

Connectives

Type	Role
Transitions	Move to the next idea
Internal previews	Announce what comes next
Internal summaries	Recap points so far

Theories, principles, models and contributors

BODY BETRAYS THE SPEAKER — SIGMUND FREUD

The body speaks even when the lips are silent.

MODEST SPEECH, STRONG ACTION — CONFUCIUS

A superior man is modest in his speech but exceeds in his actions.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Speaker forgetting half of his opening quotation.

EXAMPLE

Dentist humour.

EXAMPLE

OHP presenter standing between the transparency and the audience.

EXAMPLE

Self-recording on a cell phone.

Comparison tables

PPT used well versus poorly

Point	Used well	Used poorly
Text	Few key points	Full paragraphs
Speaker	Talks with the audience	Reads from the slides
Result	Engagement	Dull, like reading a manuscript

Slow versus fast speaking

Point	Moderate rate (120–130 wpm)	Very fast (180 wpm)
Clarity	High	Words lost
Audience	Comfortable	Strained
Speaker	Controlled	Runs out of ideas

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Start with a question, story, anecdote or startling fact.
- Memorise opening and closing lines.
- Rate cited: 120–130 words per minute.
- Do not read slides.
- Time yourself and record your practice.
- Dress formally; check appearance.
- Do not stand between aid and audience.
- Use connectives and signposts.
- Freud: the body speaks.
- Confucius: modest in speech, exceed in action.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W10 Q4	p.34	Effective oral presentation	MCQ
W10 Q7	p.35	Combating nervousness	MCQ
W11 Q1	p.37	Delivery of presentations	MCQ
W11 Q2	p.37	Evaluating presentations	MCQ
W11 Q11	p.39	Evaluating presentations	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

An effective presentation opens with a captivating hook, uses a clear voice at a moderate rate, appropriate volume and varied pitch, supportive body language and eye contact, humour and familiar examples, well-integrated aids and signposts, and an emphatic ending. Success depends on rehearsal: outline, timing, recording and feedback. Slides should be an outline, not a script. On the day, begin with a pause, stay natural, dress formally, handle questions gracefully and end with a summary. Freud reminds that the body speaks; Confucius that a superior man is modest in speech.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which is a good way to begin a presentation?

A. An abrupt start

B. A startling fact or question

C. A long apology

D. Reading the title slowly

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Capture attention.

Q2 (MCQ) Reading from slides is equivalent to:

A. Extemporaneous speaking

B. Reading from a manuscript

C. Impromptu speaking

D. Debating

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It is dull.

Q3 (MSQ) Aids to practice include:

A. Timing with a clock

B. Recording on a cell phone

C. Using a mirror

D. Never rehearsing

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Rehearsal builds confidence.

Q4 (T/F) A speaker may stand between the visual aid and the audience.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** It blocks the view.

Q5 (Fill) Speakers should begin with a _____ rather than rush.

> **Answer:** pause
> **Why:** Stress buster.

Q6 (Short) What are connectives in a talk?

> **Answer:** Transitions, internal previews and internal summaries that signal movement from one idea to the next.
> **Why:** Replace punctuation in speech.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list features of an effective presentation.

☐ I know how to rehearse.

☐ I know delivery factors.

☐ I can use slides properly.

☐ I recall Freud and Confucius.

Lecture 52: Speeches for Various Occasions

Week 11 · Course book PDF pages 852–868 (printed pages 851–867)

Learning objectives

- Explain why professionals need to give occasion speeches.
- Differentiate speeches from presentations.
- Stress the importance of the beginning and closing, with the Antony and Frost illustrations.
- Describe the types: welcome, introductory, felicitation, commemorative, farewell, vote of thanks.
- State the do’s of each type.

Important definitions

SPEECH

A formal, subjective, emotion-soaked oral address for a specific occasion, without visual aids, depending on voice and language.

WELCOME SPEECH

A speech welcoming the chief guest and the audience, with accurate facts about the guest.

INTRODUCTORY SPEECH

A speech introducing a guest or speaker to the audience, praising achievements without embarrassment or exaggeration.

FELICITATION SPEECH

A speech honouring and celebrating a person’s achievements or award.

COMMEMORATIVE SPEECH

A speech honouring the memory of a person who is no more, in a sorrowful tone.

FAREWELL SPEECH

A leave-taking speech, in a subdued tone, by the organisation or by the departing person.

VOTE OF THANKS

Closing speech thanking everyone in order of seniority with reasons, briefly and warmly.

Core concepts

Why speeches

- We maintain social and professional relationships; occasions arise at work: welcoming guests, retirements, honours, tributes, farewells.
- Notice may be only a day or two, so always be ready.

Speech versus presentation

- Presentation: technical, complex, objective, with visual aids.
- Speech: emotional, sentimental, subjective, **no visual aids**; the speaker is the visual.
- Language: may be ornate or figurative but must stay **simple** and understandable; style varies by occasion.

Power of opening and closing

- The beginning should generate **intimacy**; the closing leaves a lasting impression (**Longfellow**: great is the art of beginning, but greater the art of ending).
- **Opening illustration:** in Shakespeare's *Julius Caesar* Antony wins over a hostile crowd by a courteous, subtle opening that asks for their attention and gradually reverses their opinion of Caesar as a traitor; 'half the battle is won in the beginning'.
- **Closing illustration:** a convocation address ending with a famous poem's lines about promises to keep and miles to go (Robert Frost) reminds graduates that life is a greater examination.

Welcome speech

- Gather facts about the guest; get the name and achievements exactly right.
- Welcome the chair, dignitaries, the guest **and the audience**; say why the guest is important and how the audience will benefit.
- Example: welcoming a renowned Indian English poet-novelist to a conference of English teachers.

Introductory speech

- Start with salutations and an engaging note; give achievements in short sentences.
- Do not speak too long; no embarrassing or untrue claims.
- Example: introducing Mukesh Ambani – joined Reliance in 1981, chairman in 2002, awards for telecom; end by inviting applause.

Felicitation speech

- Honour achievements; talk about the laurel, award or recognition and its impact.
- Example: felicitating a nominee to the World Bank for work benefiting farmers; use auspicious, respectful language.

Commemorative speech

- Honour the memory of a departed person; talk of loss and contribution.
- Tone is sorrowful; words figurative and suited to the occasion.
- Example: Pandit Nehru's address on the death of Mahatma Gandhi – light gone out, 'Bapu', 'Father of the Nation'.

Farewell speech

- Subdued tone; talk of the person's association and contribution; mention that he will be missed.
- If you are the one leaving: control emotions, thank organisers, be polite, brief and humble; do not exaggerate your contribution.
- No criticism and no excessive praise.

Vote of thanks

- Acknowledge everyone, in order of seniority, with **reasons**; include supporting staff.
- Brief but warm; change the language from the report acknowledgement; a touch of humour is welcome.
- Example: 'I am thankful to Mr X for his valuable contribution…'.

Closing quotation

Buddha: the wise fashion speech with thought, sifting it as grain is sifted through a sieve – speak only filtered, valuable thoughts. Work hopefully and prepare for every speech situation.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of occasion speeches

Type	Purpose	Tone / key point
Welcome	Welcome guest and audience	Respectful; accurate facts
Introductory	Introduce the speaker	Concise; no exaggeration
Felicitation	Honour achievements	Celebratory
Commemorative	Remember the departed	Sorrowful, subdued
Farewell	Bid goodbye	Warm, humble, brief
Vote of thanks	Thank all	Ordered, brief, warm

Theories, principles, models and contributors

ART OF ENDING — HENRY WADSWORTH LONGFELLOW (AS CITED)

Great is the art of beginning, but greater the art of ending.

SPEECH AS SIFTED THOUGHT — BUDDHA (AS CITED)

The wise shape speech with thought, sifting it like grain through a sieve.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Antony's funeral speech from Julius Caesar (opening).

EXAMPLE

Convocation address closing with lines from Robert Frost.

EXAMPLE

Nehru’s speech on Gandhi’s death.

EXAMPLE

Welcome to Prof. Shiv Kumar; introduction of Mukesh Ambani; felicitation on World Bank nomination.

Comparison tables

Speech versus presentation

Point	Speech	Presentation
Nature	Emotional, subjective	Technical, objective
Visual aids	None	Yes
Language	Ornate/figurative but simple	Plain, factual
Purpose	Occasion (honour, thanks, welcome)	Inform/persuade

Welcome versus introductory speech

Point	Welcome	Introductory
Addressee	Guest and audience	Audience about the speaker
Content	Gratitude and welcome	Achievements and background

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Six speech types: welcome, introductory, felicitation, commemorative, farewell, vote of thanks.
- Speeches have no visual aids.
- Beginning generates intimacy; closing leaves a lasting impression.
- Welcome speech welcomes both guest and audience.
- Do not exaggerate in introductions or farewells.
- Commemorative speech uses a sorrowful tone.
- Vote of thanks follows seniority and gives reasons.
- Longfellow: art of ending.
- Buddha: speech sifted like grain.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W11 Q3	p.37	Vote of thanks	MCQ
W11 Q4	p.37	Welcome speech vs vote of thanks	MCQ
W11 Q12	p.39	Opening and closing a speech	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Professionals must be ready to give speeches on occasions. Unlike presentations, speeches are emotional, subjective and without visual aids, so language, style, and especially the opening and closing matter, as illustrated by Antony's speech and a convocation ending. The six types are welcome, introductory, felicitation, commemorative, farewell and vote of thanks, each with its own tone and conventions: accurate facts, respect, no exaggeration, humility, brevity and warmth. Speak only sifted, valuable thoughts.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which speech honours the memory of a departed person?

A. Welcome
B. Felicitation
C. Commemorative
D. Vote of thanks

> **Answer:** C
> **Why:** Delivered in a sorrowful tone.

Q2 (MCQ) Visual aids are normally used in:

A. Speeches
B. Oral presentations
C. Farewell speeches
D. Vote of thanks

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Speeches rely on the speaker.

Q3 (MSQ) A vote of thanks should be:

A. In order of seniority

B. Brief

C. With reasons for thanks

D. Critical

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Never critical.

Q4 (T/F) A farewell speech should criticise the departing person.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** No criticism or exaggeration.

Q5 (Fill) A speech's beginning should generate _____.

> **Answer:** intimacy
> **Why:** It connects with the crowd.

Q6 (Short) What should be done in a welcome speech?

> **Answer:** Welcome the chief guest and the audience, state the guest's identity and importance accurately, and explain how the audience will benefit.
> **Why:** Gather accurate facts.

Revision checklist

☐ I can differentiate speech and presentation.

☐ I can list six types.

☐ I know each type's tone.

☐ I know how to open and close.

☐ I recall Longfellow and Buddha.

Lecture 53: Interviews

Week 11 · Course book PDF pages 869–884 (printed pages 868–883)

Learning objectives

- Define an interview and explain the origin of the word.
- List the types of interview: informative, persuasive, exit, evaluation, counselling, conflict resolution, disciplinary, termination, job.
- State general skills needed by an interviewee.
- Describe the stages of the recruitment process.
- List attributes recruiters look for.

Important definitions

INTERVIEW

A face-to-face, mostly oral, systematic communication in which an interviewer tests the traits and qualities of an interviewee for a purpose; from French ‘entrevue’ (a sight between), glossed in the lecture as ‘to see the other person’.

INTERVIEWER / INTERVIEWEE

The person taking the interview / the person being interviewed.

INFORMATION-GATHERING INTERVIEW

An interview to collect data, e.g. by phone or Skype when time is short.

PERSUASIVE INTERVIEW

An interview to convince a person, e.g. to close a deal or to correct performance.

EXIT INTERVIEW

An interview with a departing employee to learn problems and get valuable suggestions.

EVALUATION INTERVIEW

A periodic progress review between a senior and a subordinate.

COUNSELLING INTERVIEW

An interview to motivate and boost the morale of employees.

CONFLICT-RESOLUTION INTERVIEW

An interview to resolve conflict between departments or persons.

DISCIPLINARY INTERVIEW

A fact-finding interview by a disciplinary committee after a mistake.

TERMINATION INTERVIEW

An interview before ending an employee's service (may involve a 'golden handshake').

STRESS INTERVIEW

An interview that tests the candidate in a stressful situation with challenging questions.

SCREENING

First stage where applications and CVs are sifted.

Core concepts

Nature of an interview

- Occurs in jobs, admissions, hospitals, hostels and organisations throughout life.
- Orality combined with non-verbal skills.
- **Pauline V. Young:** an interview is a systematic method by which a person enters imaginatively into the inner life of a comparative stranger.
- Nervousness arises because interviewers are strangers.

Types of interviews

1. **Informative** (data collection; telephonic, Skype).
2. **Persuasive** (convincing in deals or to improve performance).
3. **Exit** – leaving employees give honest, constructive inputs; avoid bad-mouthing.
4. **Evaluation** – progress reviews.
5. **Counselling** – morale boosting.
6. **Conflict resolution** between departments.
7. **Disciplinary** – fact finding.
8. **Termination** – final discussion; golden handshake.
9. **Job interview** (selection).

Skills for the interviewee

- **Confidence** – built by understanding the purpose and gathering information.
- Listen carefully to the whole question before answering.
- Anticipate questions; use intelligence for tricky ones (like Yorkers, googlies and bouncers in cricket).
- Use formal language; no informal expressions.

- Know your strengths and weaknesses; present weaknesses so they become merits; avoid over- or underestimating yourself.
- Understand the interviewer's needs and expectations.
- Behave well: every person present is observing.

Importance of preparation

John D. Singleton: "Very often the difference between the person hired and the person rejected is not who is the better candidate, but who is better prepared for the interview." Years of learning are judged in half an hour; careers can be made or lost there.

Stages of recruitment

1. **Screening** of applications and CVs (saleable résumé is essential).
2. **Competency tests** to eliminate candidates.
3. **Psychological tests.**
4. **Group discussion** / case.
5. **Negotiation.**
6. **Stress interview.**
7. **Medical test** (last).

What recruiters look for

- A good person, competent, an asset to the organisation; well informed and well rounded; good personality.
- **Attitude, adaptability, aptitude, behaviour, team spirit and dynamics.**
- Clarity of purpose, thought and expression; decision-making ability.
- Originality and innovative mind; cheerful disposition.
- Find information through newspapers (e.g. Times of India Ascent), Employment News and company websites.

Getting started

Mark Twain: the secret of getting ahead is getting started. Build confidence, revise the lectures on personality and positive thinking, prepare a good résumé to get the call (next lecture).

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of interviews and purposes

Type	Purpose
Information gathering	Collect data quickly
Persuasive	Convince or correct
Exit	Learn from departing employee
Evaluation	Review progress
Counselling	Boost morale
Conflict resolution	Settle disputes
Disciplinary	Find facts on misconduct
Termination	End service
Job	Select candidates

Stages of recruitment

Stage	Purpose
Screening	Sift CVs
Competency test	Test skills
Psychological test	Assess personality
Group discussion	Observe behaviour
Negotiation	Test bargaining
Stress interview	Test under pressure
Medical test	Final fitness check

Theories, principles, models and contributors

INTERVIEW AS SYSTEMATIC METHOD — PAULINE V. YOUNG

An interview is a systematic method by which a person imaginatively enters the inner life of a comparative stranger.

PREPARATION DECIDES SELECTION — JOHN D. SINGLETON

The hired candidate is often the better prepared, not the better.

GETTING AHEAD — MARK TWAIN

The secret of getting ahead is getting started.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Telephonic or Skype interview for data collection.

EXAMPLE

Exit interview of a long-serving employee.

EXAMPLE

Counselling interview after poor performance.

EXAMPLE

Cricket analogy: Yorkers, googlies, bouncers for tricky questions.

Comparison tables

Exit versus termination interview

Point	Exit interview	Termination interview
Initiator	Employee leaving	Employer ending service
Purpose	Feedback and inputs	Final discussion / settlement
Tone	Constructive	Formal, sensitive

Informative versus persuasive interview

Point	Informative	Persuasive
Aim	Collect information	Change opinion/action
Example	Telephonic data collection	Persuading a client or employee

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Interview: face-to-face, mostly oral, systematic.
- Pauline V. Young's definition.
- Types include exit, evaluation, counselling, conflict resolution, disciplinary and termination.
- Develop confidence by gathering information.
- Listen fully before answering.
- Use formal language.
- Stages: screening, competency test, psychological test, GD, negotiation, stress interview, medical.
- Recruiters seek attitude, adaptability, aptitude, team spirit.
- Singleton: preparation decides.
- Twain: get started.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W11 Q5	p.37	Types of interviews	MCQ
W11 Q6	p.38	Job interview process	MCQ

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

An interview is a systematic, mostly oral face-to-face method to test an interviewee's traits; it has many forms: informative, persuasive, exit, evaluation, counselling, conflict resolution, disciplinary, termination and job interviews. Success needs confidence from information, careful listening, anticipation of questions, formal language, awareness of strengths and weaknesses and understanding the interviewer's expectations. Recruitment proceeds through screening, tests, GD, negotiation, stress interview and medical test; recruiters seek attitude, adaptability, aptitude, team spirit and clarity. Preparation (Singleton) and getting started (Twain) matter most.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) Which interview is held with a departing employee?

A. Exit

B. Persuasive

C. Disciplinary

D. Evaluation

> **Answer:** A
> **Why:** To gain constructive inputs.

Q2 (MCQ) Which stage comes last in recruitment?

A. Screening

B. GD

C. Stress interview

D. Medical test

> **Answer:** D
> **Why:** Medical test comes last.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are types of interview?

A. Counselling

B. Conflict resolution

C. Disciplinary

D. Advertisement

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Advertisement is not an interview.

Q4 (T/F) Informal language is acceptable in interviews.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Use formal language.

Q5 (Fill) A first stage of recruitment is _____ of applications.

> **Answer:** screening
> **Why:** CVs are sifted.

Q6 (Short) What does a counselling interview aim at?

> **Answer:** To motivate employees and boost their morale after problems or poor performance.
> **Why:** Also used in schools.

Revision checklist

☐ I can define interview.

☐ I know the types.

☐ I know the stages of recruitment.

☐ I know recruiters' expectations.

☐ I recall Young, Singleton, Twain.

Lecture 54: Planning and Preparation: Part-1

Week 11 · Course book PDF pages 885–902 (printed pages 884–901)

Learning objectives

- List the preparatory steps before applying for a job.
- Explain self-analysis: who am I, achievements, strengths, weaknesses, values, personality, background, hobbies and career goals.
- Explain why researching the organisation and the job position matters.
- Differentiate intuitive skills from learned skills.
- Describe the interview file and the will to win.

Important definitions

SELF-ANALYSIS

Honest examination of one's qualifications, achievements, strengths, weaknesses, values, personality and goals before choosing a job.

USP (UNIQUE SELLING PRODUCT/PROPOSITION)

The one skill in which a person is most confident, which becomes a personal trademark for which they are called.

INTUITIVE SKILLS

Skills already present within a person, such as adaptability, assertiveness, creativity, resourcefulness and discretion, which can be further developed.

LEARNED SKILLS

Skills acquired through effort, such as computer programming, marketing, interpersonal skills, speaking, organising events, time management, coordination, leadership and writing.

INTERVIEW FILE

An organised file of résumé, certificates, degrees, experience letters, awards, scholarships and newspaper clippings prepared before the interview.

CORPORATE CULTURE

The work culture, language, values and ways of functioning of an organisation.

PANEL INTERVIEW

An interview in which several people judge the candidate together.

WILL TO WIN

The desire to succeed and the urge to reach one's full potential (Confucius, as cited).

Core concepts

Preparatory steps

1. **Analyse yourself** (self-analysis).
2. **Identify your skills.**
3. **Research the organisation.**
4. **Know the job position** (roles, responsibilities, expectations).
5. **Revise subject knowledge** and update skills.
6. Draft the **résumé** and build the interview file.

Choice alone is not the only ingredient in getting a job; qualification, skills and fit matter. Choosing a career in line with one's qualification avoids becoming a misfit.

Know yourself: who am I?

- People either underestimate or overestimate themselves.
- Ask 'Who am I?': think of qualifications, achievements (debates, speeches, sports, best paper award) and strengths.
- Everyone has some quality: speaking, writing, convincing, leadership, initiative, computing (C++, Oracle).
- Match strengths to jobs: good talkers and interviewers suit HR or placement cells.

Planning, goals and values

- Have a plan: e.g. write books, become CEO, head the training and placement cell, general manager or regional head.
- Be clear about goals; review past achievements (papers, patents, books, contribution to the field).
- Prioritise the skill in which you are most confident; it becomes your **USP**.
- Decide what you **value**: money, status, power, position, recognition as a researcher, administrative acumen.
- Values shape the job choice: administrative service for those wanting a group; a laboratory or cabin for researchers.

Personality and behaviour

- Do you work with a group or in isolation? A person who wants to work in isolation is not fit for today's organisations.
- Mental alertness, anticipation and foresight (a visionary).
- Work style: aggressive or democratic; slow but steady; perfectionist or specialist.
- How fast or slow you think.

Background, hobbies and goals

- Background: schools, exposure to the outside world, accomplishments (grades, distinctions, papers).

- Hobbies and interests may be asked, since recruiters want a **well-rounded** person, not merely bookish; workplace requires social relationships and responsibility.
- Career goals must be defined.

Research the organisation

- Visit the company website (e.g. Wipro, Infosys, L&T, Reliance, Reliance Jio): operations, growth rate, history, work culture, language of correspondence, new products.
- Know the corporate culture, faiths and cultures of an MNC workforce and the language used.
- Questions may come from the organisation's recent achievements; be updated.

Know the job

- Understand roles, responsibilities, challenges, special duties, career prospects, enhancement opportunities and promotions.
- You may be asked which task you can do more comfortably; psychologists may create challenging situations to test your response.
- Anticipate beforehand.

Update subject knowledge and skills

- Revise subject knowledge; a master's done long ago needs updating.
- A skilled person never sits idle (e.g. a cobbler, car or bike mechanic).
- Today's organisations need multiple skills; a person who says he will do only one job is a 'gone case'.

Intuitive and learned skills

- **Intuitive (inborn):** adaptability, assertiveness, creativity, resourcefulness, efficiency, leadership, broad-mindedness, discretion, ability to assimilate differing opinions.
- **Learned:** computer/programming skills, marketing and deal making, interpersonal skills, speaking on occasions, organising events/conferences/workshops, training, time management, coordination, administrative and leadership skills, writing for different occasions.

Interview file and will to win

- Develop the interview file well in advance; do not be at 'sixes and sevens' on the day.
- Contents: **résumé that sells**, certificates, degrees, diplomas in proper order, experience certificates, conference/competition/workshop certificates, awards, scholarships, fellowships, newspaper clippings for a quick glance.
- Be confident that the recruiter is waiting for you.
- **Confucius (as cited):** "The will to win, the desire to succeed, the urge to reach your full potential: these are the keys that will unlock the door to personal excellence."
- Winners do things with a difference; those not selected get another chance.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Intuitive versus learned skills

Intuitive skills	Learned skills
Adaptability	Computer programming
Assertiveness	Marketing and deal making
Creativity	Interpersonal and speaking skills
Resourcefulness	Time management
Discretion, broad-mindedness	Coordination, leadership, writing

Self-analysis checklist

Aspect	Question
Identity	Who am I?
Achievements	What have I accomplished?
Strengths and weaknesses	What are my qualities?
Values	Money, status, power or recognition?
Personality	Group or isolation; fast or slow?
Background	Education, exposure, hobbies
Goals	Where do I want to be?

Theories, principles, models and contributors

WILL TO WIN — CONFUCIUS (AS CITED)

The will to win, the desire to succeed and the urge to reach full potential unlock personal excellence.

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

A graduate in a relevant field switching to an unrelated job becomes a misfit.

EXAMPLE

Applying to Wipro, Infosys, L&T or Reliance Jio: study the website.

EXAMPLE

Someone with strong speaking and convincing ability choosing HR, placement or recruitment cell.

EXAMPLE

Cobbler and mechanic as skilled people who never sit idle.

Comparison tables

Intuitive versus learned skills

Point	Intuitive	Learned
Source	Within the person	Acquired by effort
Examples	Adaptability, creativity, assertiveness	Programming, marketing, writing, time management
Action	Explore and develop	Learn and practise

Underestimating versus overestimating oneself

Point	Underestimating	Overestimating
Result	Missed opportunities	Unrealistic job choices
Remedy	Self-analysis	Self-analysis

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- First preparatory step: analyse yourself.
- Second: identify your skills.
- Research the organisation and the job position.
- Revise subject knowledge.
- Skills are intuitive or learned.
- USP: unique selling product.
- A person working in isolation is unfit for today’s organisations.
- Recruiters prefer well-rounded candidates.
- Interview file contains résumé, certificates, awards and clippings.
- Confucius quoted on the will to win.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W11 Q7	p.38	Self-analysis for interviews	MCQ
W11 Q8	p.38	Job analysis	MCQ
W11 Q15	p.39	Interview file	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

Preparation for an interview begins long before the call. Analyse yourself honestly (qualifications, achievements, strengths, weaknesses, values, personality, background, hobbies, goals), identify and prioritise your skills to form a USP, and research both the organisation (website, growth, culture, new products) and the job (roles, responsibilities, prospects). Revise subject knowledge and update skills. Skills are intuitive (adaptability, assertiveness, creativity, resourcefulness) or learned (computer, marketing, speaking, time management, leadership, writing). Build an interview file and a saleable résumé, and keep the will to win.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) The first preparatory step before applying for a job is:

A. Writing a résumé

B. Self-analysis

C. Medical test

D. Salary negotiation

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Analyse yourself first.

Q2 (MCQ) Which of these is an intuitive skill?

A. Computer programming

B. Adaptability

C. Time management

D. Report writing

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** Adaptability is within us; others are learned.

Q3 (MSQ) Which belong in an interview file?

A. Certificates

B. Awards and scholarships

C. Newspaper clippings

D. Other candidates' résumés

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Only your own documents.

Q4 (T/F) A person who prefers working in isolation suits today's organisations well.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Group work is essential.

Q5 Fill The skill in which one is most confident becomes one's _____.

> **Answer:** USP
> **Why:** Unique selling product.

Q6 Short Why should a candidate research the organisation before an interview?

> **Answer:** Questions may be asked about its growth, culture, products and work environment, and knowing them shows interest and helps present oneself as a fit.
> **Why:** Use the company website.

Revision checklist

☐ I can list preparatory steps.
☐ I can do a self-analysis.
☐ I know intuitive versus learned skills.
☐ I know how to research an organisation and job.
☐ I know the contents of an interview file.

Lecture 55: Planning and Preparation: Part II

Week 11 · Course book PDF pages 903–924 (printed pages 902–923)

Learning objectives

- Differentiate résumé and CV with their etymologies.
- State the purpose and requirements of a standard résumé.
- List special skills and personal attributes recruiters want.
- Describe the three formats: chronological, functional, hybrid.
- Explain the parts of a résumé opening: heading, career objective, summary of qualification.
- State do’s and don’ts of résumé writing.

Important definitions

RÉSUMÉ

From French, ‘to summarise’: a document summarising one’s achievements, education, experience and future intentions to create interest in one’s candidature.

CURRICULUM VITAE (CV)

From Latin, ‘the course of life’ / details of qualification: a more detailed document than a résumé; the two terms are often used interchangeably.

CAREER OBJECTIVE

A specific statement of the position sought and the skills to be used, expressing short- and long-term goals.

CHRONOLOGICAL RÉSUMÉ

Lists experience in time order from the latest to the earliest; suits experienced candidates.

FUNCTIONAL (SKILL) RÉSUMÉ

Emphasises skills and abilities; suits entry-level candidates.

HYBRID / COMBINATIONAL RÉSUMÉ

A mix of chronological and functional formats.

ACTION VERBS

Past-tense verbs that ‘speak’, such as accomplished, assisted, demonstrated, identified, investigated, participated, supervised, streamlined.

REFERENCES (REFEREES)

People who can verify one's capability; supplied if asked.

SCANNABLE RÉSUMÉ

A résumé on good-quality paper that can be scanned or sent as an attachment.

Core concepts

Résumé versus CV

- **Résumé** (French): a summary; **CV** (Latin): curriculum vitae, more detailed.
- Used interchangeably; some organisations ask for one, some for the other.
- A résumé accompanies an **application letter**.

Purpose of a résumé

- The first round of selection (elimination) is through the résumé.
- Its purpose is to **kindle interest** in your candidature and win an **interview call**.
- Many candidates fail by being too weighty or poorly framed.

Requirements of a standard résumé

- **Formatted** (no handwritten résumé today) in a systematic manner; many organisations give a proforma, others test your own format.
- **Specific** to the advertised post and its required skills.
- **Error-free** in grammar and spelling.
- Broken into units, with **crisp phrases** and specific words; use **action verbs**.
- Positive image: 'sell' yourself (e.g. academically gifted, leader); relate your best features and relegate weaknesses; do not overestimate yourself.

Contents

- Career goals/objective, education, work experience, activities, honours, rewards, awards, special skills, references.

Special skills

- **Computer proficiency** (paperless office).
- **Foreign-language** proficiency (multicultural workplaces).
- **Writing** ability and interpersonal/human skills.
- **Problem-solving** and **decision-making**.

Personal attributes

- Enthusiasm, initiative, motivation, adaptability, sense of humour, friendliness; also gregarious, self-starter, manager, good speaker/writer, creative, communicative.
- Today's organisations are people organisations.

Education, experience and references

- **Education:** school, college, university, other courses.
- **Experience:** even brief or small experiences count; freshers can cite fests, group projects, reports, responsibilities, with their **role** clearly stated.
- Mention gaps and job changes accurately; longer service helps; be honest if terminated (they may ask).
- **References:** former or present employers, colleagues, professors; **not relatives**; write 'available on request' and give only when asked.

Types of résumé

1. **Chronological** – experienced; latest to earliest; shows work style.
2. **Functional / skill** – entry-level; highlights skills.
3. **Hybrid / combinational** – blend of the two.

Opening of a résumé

- **Heading:** exact name as on certificates (no nickname), permanent and campus address, an active phone number, a frequently checked email, and URL/web page if any.
- **Career objective:** specific, not generalised. Examples: 'To obtain a position as a software engineer allowing me to utilise my knowledge of Oracle and Linux'; 'To obtain a post of marketing support representative where skills in administration and management, program development, public relations and writing can be used'.
- **Summary of qualification:** start with the highest qualification, in order (e.g. B.Tech in computer science with specialisation in networking).

Style and length

- Use active statements and phrases consistently, not a mix of sentences and phrases; begin with action verbs; avoid weak words like 'help'; avoid 'I was in charge of…'.
- **Length:** 1 to 1.5 pages for entry-level candidates; even one page is fine if it shows skills.
- Use good-quality paper; the résumé may be scanned.

Do's and don'ts

- **Do:** mention major activities, job objective, use proper headings, be honest, be specific, update regularly.
- **Don't:** write an autobiography; list every strength (keep something for the interview); mention salary; criticise a previous employer; overestimate yourself.
- Statements in the résumé must match reality.

Types, classifications and characteristics

Types of résumé

Type	Basis	Best for
Chronological	Time order (latest to earliest)	Experienced candidates
Functional (skill)	Skills and abilities	Entry-level candidates
Hybrid / combinational	Mix of both	Mixed profiles

Sections of a résumé opening

Section	Content
Heading	Name, address, phone, email, URL
Career objective	Specific position and skills to be used
Summary of qualification	Highest qualification first

Examples and applications

EXAMPLE

Career objective: software engineer using Oracle and Linux.

EXAMPLE

Career objective: marketing support representative using administration, program development, PR and writing.

EXAMPLE

Action verbs: accomplished, assisted, demonstrated, identified, investigated, participated, supervised, streamlined.

EXAMPLE

Freshers citing college fests (techno fests, Cognizance) and group projects.

Comparison tables

Résumé versus CV

Point	Résumé	CV
Origin	French: summary	Latin: course of life
Detail	Brief summary	More detailed
Usage	Often interchangeable	Often interchangeable

Chronological versus functional résumé

Point	Chronological	Functional
Focus	Work history in time order	Skills
Suits	Experienced	Entry-level
Other name	–	Skill résumé

Weak versus strong wording

Weak	Strong
I was in charge of the lab for two years	Supervised the fluid mechanics lab for two years
Helped with...	Assisted / streamlined / demonstrated...

Important facts for MCQ revision

EXAM TIP

- Résumé is French for summary; CV is Latin.
- Purpose: to get an interview call.
- No handwritten résumés today.
- Résumé must be specific, error-free, formatted.
- Use action verbs in the past tense.
- Three types: chronological, functional (skill), hybrid.
- Length for entry-level: 1 to 1.5 pages.
- Heading: real name, address, phone, email, URL.
- Do not give references unless asked; avoid relatives.
- Do not mention salary or criticise previous employer.

QUIZ-RELATED CONCEPTS (QUIZ PDF PAGE REFERENCES)

Question	Quiz PDF page	Concept tested	Type
W11 Q9	p.38	Purpose of a résumé	MCQ
W11 Q10	p.38	Résumé guidelines	MCQ
W11 Q14	p.39	Résumé length	True/False
W12 Q11	p.42	Résumé: references	True/False

Full question text and answers: Quiz analysis.

Summary

A résumé (French: summary) or CV (Latin: course of life) is a formatted, specific, error-free document that kindles interest and secures an interview call. It presents career objective, education, experience,

activities, honours, skills (computer, foreign language, writing, problem solving, decision making) and attributes (enthusiasm, initiative, motivation, adaptability, humour). Formats are chronological (experienced), functional/skill (entry-level) and hybrid. Open with heading, a specific career objective and qualifications from highest downward; use action verbs, keep to 1–1.5 pages, give references only on request, and never mention salary, criticise employers or overestimate yourself.

Practice questions

Q1 (MCQ) A functional résumé is also called a:

A. Chronological résumé

B. Skill résumé

C. Hybrid résumé

D. CV

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It highlights skills.

Q2 (MCQ) The word ‘résumé’ comes from:

A. Latin

B. French

C. Greek

D. German

> **Answer:** B
> **Why:** It means to summarise.

Q3 (MSQ) Which are special skills recruiters look for?

A. Computer proficiency

B. Foreign language

C. Problem solving

D. Salary demand

> **Answer:** A, B, C
> **Why:** Salary should not be mentioned.

Q4 (T/F) References should include relatives who will praise you.

> **Answer:** False
> **Why:** Use employers or professors, and only when asked.

Q5 (Fill) The recommended length of a fresher’s résumé is 1 to _____ pages.

> **Answer:** 1.5
> **Why:** Not longer.

Q6 Short What is a career objective?

> **Answer:** A specific statement of the position sought and the skills to be used, expressing the candidate's aims.
> **Why:** Avoid generalised objectives.

Revision checklist

☐ I can differentiate résumé and CV.
☐ I know the three formats.
☐ I can write a heading and career objective.
☐ I can use action verbs.
☐ I know the do's and don'ts.